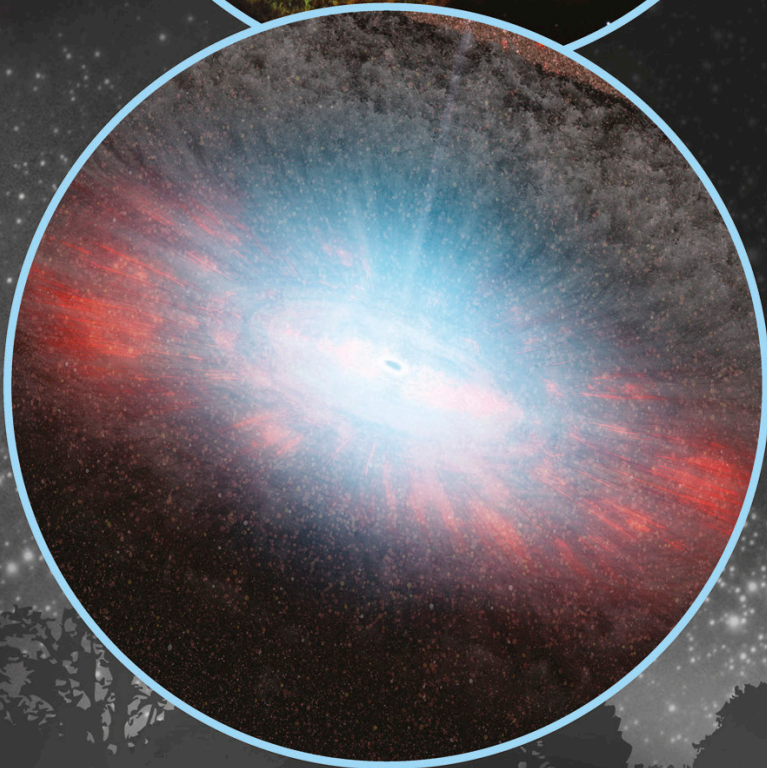
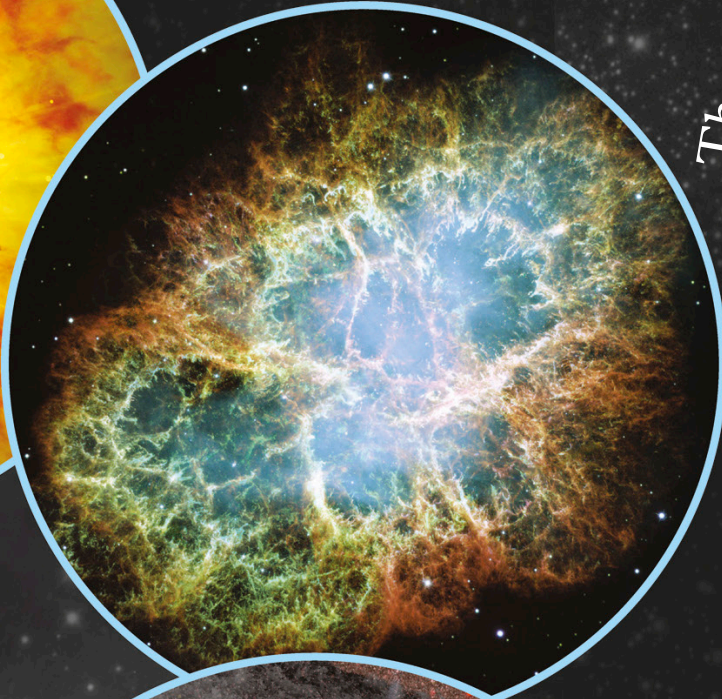
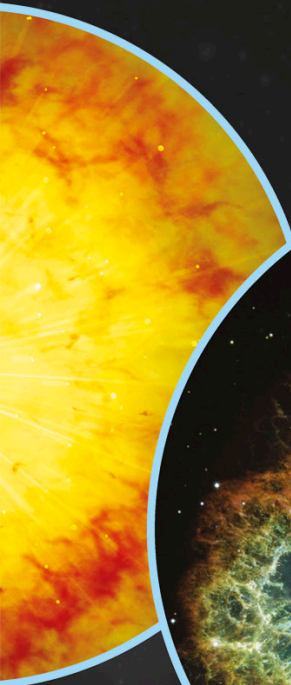


The Sun is made mostly of hydrogen.

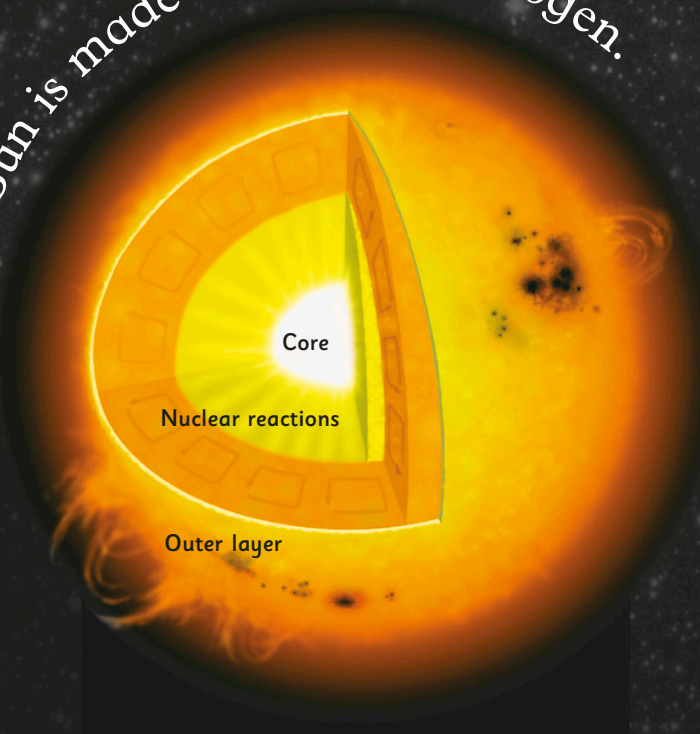
Remnants

The fragments of the star can remain glowing in space for hundreds of years.



Black holes

When the biggest stars explode, most material is blown outward. But the core is crushed and collapses to form a black hole.



Starshine

Our Sun is a star that is halfway through its life. In the life cycle, it sits between being formed within a nebula and becoming a red giant.



Shapes in the sky

Hundreds of years ago, people grouped stars that appear close together in the sky into shapes called constellations. They all have names—often related to their shapes. This is the Big Dipper, in Ursa Major.